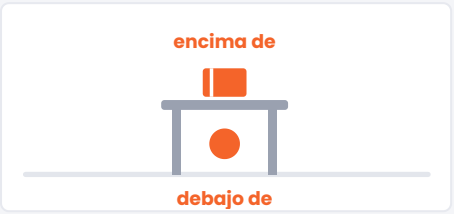
¿DÓNDE ESTÁ?
WHERE THINGS ARE

grey is the thing you are talking about — orange is what you are placing

1. Twelve pictures, twelve sentences each one is a card you already have — the opposite is drawn alongside it



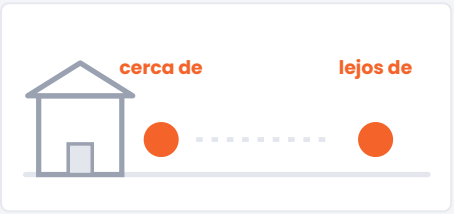
El libro está **encima de** la mesa.
y el gato duerme **debajo**



Las llaves están **dentro del** bolso.
fuera de is the other side of the same word



El coche está **delante de** la casa.
the door tells you which side is the front



El banco está **cerca de** mi casa.
and **lejos del** centro



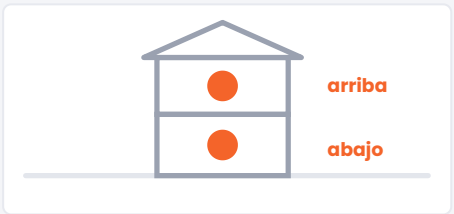
a la izquierda / a la derecha de
the only pair that names a side



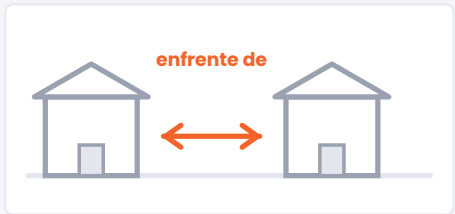
La farmacia está **al lado del** banco.
junto a means right up against it



Mi casa está **entre** el parque y la iglesia.
and **alrededor de** is all the way round



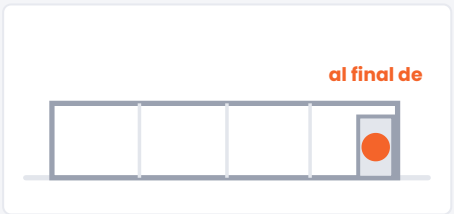
El baño está **abajo**.
neither **arriba** nor **abajo** takes *de*



El supermercado está **enfrente del** colegio.
facing it, across the street



en la mesa · **en** el bolso
one Spanish word for English *on* and *in*

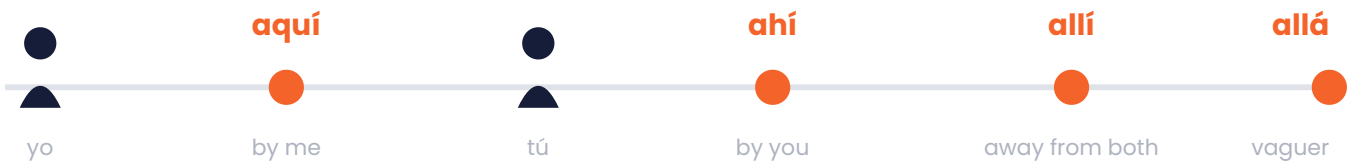


El baño está **al final del** pasillo.
right at the far end



en medio de la plaza
with things on every side

2. aquí · ahí · allí · allá English has two words for this; Spanish has four, and they measure distance from the speaker



They line up with **este · ese · aquel**: *este libro, aquí · ese libro, ahí · aquel libro, allí*. Learn them as pairs and you get both sets for the price of one.

3. They nearly all need de and the two that don't are the ones you will get wrong

encima **de** · debajo **de** · dentro **de** · fuera **de**
delante **de** · detrás **de** · al lado **de**
cerca **de** · lejos **de** · enfrente **de** · alrededor **de**
and *de + el* contracts: al lado **del** banco, lejos **del** centro

entre la mesa y la silla — no *de*, and it takes *y*
sobre la mesa — no *de* · same as *encima de*
junto **a** la ventana — this one takes *a*, not *de*
en la mesa — the everyday catch-all

The *de* only appears when something follows. *El banco está **cerca**.* — nothing after it, so no *de*. *El banco está **cerca de** mi casa.* — a noun follows, so the *de* comes back. Same for *dentro*, *delante*, *detrás*, *encima*.

All of these take **estar**, never *ser* — *el libro **está** encima de la mesa*. The one exception is an event: *la fiesta **es** en mi casa*. See **poster-ser-estar**, section 5.

Where things are
A1 — section 3 is the one to learn